Unit 1 · Prehistoric China: Primitive Society and the Origins of Chinese Civilization

第一单元 · 史前时期：原始社会与中华文明的起源

Lessons 1–3 · 第 1–3 课

Lesson 1 Human Activities in Remote Antiquity 远古时期的人类活动

Lesson 2 Primitive Agriculture and Prehistoric Society 原始农业与史前社会

Lesson 3 The Origins of Chinese Civilization 中华文明的起源

A faithful English translation of the textbook for native English speakers. Key terms are given with Chinese characters and pinyin at first mention, e.g. Peking Man（北京人 Běijīngrén）.

Source text · 底本: 人民教育出版社《中国历史》七年级上册（2024 年版）第一单元，第 2–19 页

Unit 1 Introduction 单元导言

China has a human history spanning over a million years, represented by **Yuanmou Man（元谋人 Yuánmóurén）**, **Lantian Man（蓝田人 Lántiánrén）**, **Yunxian Man（郧县人 Yúnxiànrén）**, and **Peking Man（北京人 Běijīngrén）**. Rich archaeological discoveries across the country reveal the production and everyday life of these early humans, as well as their distinctive features in the course of evolution. About 10,000 years ago, people living in the Yangtze River and Yellow River basins and other regions were already cultivating rice, foxtail millet（粟 sù）, and broomcorn millet（黍 shǔ）, raising livestock, making ground stone tools, and firing pottery — they had begun a settled life. On the basis of the rise of agriculture, primitive society continued to develop and created a rich and colourful culture. According to legend, about five to six thousand years ago, some tribes gradually formed alliances and elected leaders. The legendary Yan Emperor（炎帝 Yán Dì）and Yellow Emperor（黄帝 Huáng Dì）were outstanding representatives of this period and were honoured by later generations as the cultural ancestors of the Chinese nation. The origins and early development of Chinese civilization are characterised by pluralistic integration（多元一体 duōyuán yìtǐ）. More than 5,000 years ago, with the further development of productive forces, the population grew, cities appeared, social differentiation intensified, and early states began to emerge. Distinctive early civilizations developed in the Yellow River, Yangtze River, and West Liao River basins. More than 4,000 years ago, the Central Plains rose rapidly by extensively absorbing elements of various regional civilizations and, through sustained development, moved toward integration — a new pattern of civilization led by the Central Plains began to take shape.

■ Unit Objectives · 单元目标

1. Learn about the activities of early humans such as Yuanmou Man, Lantian Man, Yunxian Man, and Peking Man; know that China is an important region of human origins, and gain a preliminary understanding that archaeological finds are an important basis for studying human origins. 了解元谋人、蓝田人、郧县人、北京人等古人类活动，知道我国是人类起源的重要地区，初步认识考古发掘成果是研究人类起源的重要依据。

2. Know the Hemudu and Banpo sites; learn about the development of China's prehistoric culture and society, and recognise that China is one of the places where agriculture originated. 知道河姆渡、半坡等遗址，了解我国史前文化与社会的发展，认识我国是世界上农业起源地之一。

3. Know about archaeological discoveries such as Liangzhu City and Taosi City; understand that Chinese civilization has a history of more than 5,000 years, and recognise that its origins and early development are characterised by pluralistic integration. 知道良渚古城、陶寺古城等考古发现，了解中华文明有5000 多年的历史，认识中华文明的起源和初步发展具有多元一体的特征。

4. Know the ancient legends of the Yan Emperor and the Yellow Emperor, and understand the historical information they contain. 知道炎帝和黄帝等古史传说，了解其中蕴含的历史信息。

Key Dates 大事年表

Time 时间	Event 事件
c. 1.7 million years ago 距今约 170 万年	Yuanmou Man 元谋人
c. 1.6 million years ago 距今约 160 万年	Lantian Man 蓝田人
c. 1 million years ago 距今约 100 万年	Yunxian Man 郧（yún）县人
c. 700,000–200,000 years ago 距今约 70 万—20 万年	Peking Man 北京人
c. 30,000 years ago 距今约 3 万年	Upper Cave Man 山顶洞人
c. 10,000 years ago 距今约 1 万年	Early agriculture appears 早期农业出现
c. 7,000 years ago 距今约 7000 年	Hemudu site 河姆渡遗址
c. 6,000 years ago 距今约 6000 年	Banpo site 半坡遗址
c. 5300–4300 years ago 距今约 5300—4300 年	Liangzhu City site 良渚古城遗址
c. 4300–4000 years ago 距今约 4300—4000 年	Taosi City site 陶寺古城遗址

Lesson 1 · Human Activities in Remote Antiquity　第 1 课 远古时期的人类活动



An artist's impression of early human activity　古人类活动场景想象图

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.4 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 4 页

This illustration depicts a scene of early human activity. On what basis do paleoanthropologists and archaeologists study the history of early humans? When and where did the early humans of China originate? How were they different from modern humans? And what were their lives and work like?

Early Humans in China　我国境内的古人类

China is one of the countries with the greatest number of discovered early human fossils① and Paleolithic② sites in the world, and these sites are spread all across the country. Chinese scholars excavated two incisor fossils of an early human, together with some crude stone tools, at Yuanmou in Yunnan Province. Yuanmou Man, dating back about 1.7 million years, is one of the earliest known early humans within China. Lantian Man was discovered at Lantian in Shaanxi Province, where archaeologists excavated a complete skull fossil dating back about 1.6 million years. Yunxian Man was discovered at Yunyang（郧阳 Yúnyáng）in Hubei Province③; the three skull fossils excavated so far date back about 1 million years. Research on the sites of Yuanmou Man, Lantian Man, and Yunxian Man shows that they were already able to make and use tools.



Upper incisor fossils of Yuanmou Man　元谋人上门齿化石

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.4 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 4 页

Notes 注释

① The remains or traces of ancient organisms, buried in geological strata, are gradually petrified over long periods of time as minerals from the surrounding sediments seep into them; these are called “fossils”（化石 huàshí）. Fossils are important evidence for studying the history of early humans and changes in the ancient environment.

② The age before the appearance of metal tools, when humans used stone as their main production tool, is called the “Stone Age”（石器时代 Shíqì Shídài）. The period in which chipped stone tools（打制石器 dǎzhì shíqì）were mainly used is called the “Paleolithic Age”（旧石器时代 Jiùshíqì Shídài, Old Stone Age）.

③ Yunyang is a district of Shiyan City, Hubei Province; it was formerly called Yunxian（郧县）.

■ Related History · 相关史事

Humans evolved from ancient apes. Around 3 million years ago, some apes could already walk upright and make and use tools; their brain capacity increased, and they later evolved into **Homo habilis（能人 néngrén）**, and then into **Homo erectus（直立人 zhílìrén）**. About 200,000 years ago, Homo erectus evolved into humans with modern physical features — **early Homo sapiens（早期智人 zǎoqī zhìrén）**. By about 50,000 years ago, early Homo sapiens had evolved into **late Homo sapiens（晚期智人 wǎnqī zhìrén）**, i.e. modern humans.

■ Read the Map · 读地图



中国主要古人类遗址分布图

Distribution Map of Major Early Human Sites in China 中国主要古人类遗址分布图

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.5 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第5 页

Legend 图例: ● Homo erectus 直立人 ● Early Homo sapiens 早期智人 ● Late Homo sapiens 晚期智人 ◎ Capital 首都 —·— National boundary 国界 | Note 注: All elements on the map reflect present-day information（图中所有要素为今内容）.

Sites on the map 图中遗址: Yuanmou Man 元谋人 · Lantian Man 蓝田人 · Yunxian Man 郧县人 · Peking Man 北京人 · Upper Cave Man 山顶洞人 · Jinniushan Man 金牛山人 · Dingcun Man 丁村人 · Changyang Man 长阳人 · Hexian Man 和县人 · Nanjing Man 南京人 · Maba Man 马坝人 · Zuozhen Man 左镇人 | Rivers and seas 河流与海洋: Yellow River 黄河 · Yangtze River 长江 · Pearl River 珠江 · Bohai Sea 渤海 · Yellow Sea 黄海 · East China Sea 东海 · South China Sea 南海.

1. Find the sites in China where fossils of Homo erectus, early Homo sapiens, and late Homo sapiens have been discovered.

2. Find the place(s) where fossils of both Homo erectus and Homo sapiens have been discovered.

Peking Man 北京人 Běijīngrén

The Peking Man site is located on Longgu Hill（龙骨山 Lónggǔshān, “Dragon Bone Hill”）at Zhoukoudian（周口店 Zhōukǒudiàn）in Beijing, where the deposits are more than 40 metres thick. The site was first discovered in 1921. Later, based on three tooth fossils found at the site, paleoanthropologists named the early humans who had lived there “Beijing Homo erectus” or “Peking Man”. In 1929, the Chinese scholar Pei Wenzhong（裴文中 Péi Wénzhōng）discovered the first Peking Man skullcap fossil, and traces of fire use were discovered in the same year. Afterwards, five more skullcap fossils were excavated at the site; in total, Homo erectus fossils from more than 40 individuals have been unearthed, along with large quantities of animal fossils and about 100,000 chipped stone tools. The discovery of these fossils and stone tools provides important evidence for reconstructing the physical features and living conditions of Peking Man. Dating shows that Peking Man lived about 700,000–200,000 years ago.



Tooth fossil of Peking Man 北京人牙齿化石

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.5 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 5 页



Skullcap fossil of Peking Man (replica) 北京人头盖骨化石（复制品）

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.6 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 6 页

The skull of Peking Man had a low, flat forehead, thick brow ridges, protruding cheekbones, a flat nasal bone, and a forward-jutting muzzle; its brain capacity was smaller than that of modern humans①. They averaged 157 centimetres in height; their upper limbs were similar to those of modern humans, their lower limbs were slightly longer than their upper limbs, and they were able to walk upright.



Reconstructed bust of Peking Man 北京人复原头像

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.6 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 6 页

The area where Peking Man lived at that time had large stretches of forest and water, with a warm and humid climate. Water and grass were abundant, and animals such as sika deer and wild horses often roamed there. Peking Man made tools from stone chunks, animal bones, and deer antlers. Their stone-tool-making techniques were fairly mature: they could produce different types of tools, such as **choppers（砍砸器 kǎnzáqì）**, **pointed tools（尖状器 jiānzhuàngqì）**, and **scrapers（刮削器 guāxiāoqì）**. Peking Man used these tools to hunt animals and gather plant fruits. They formed groups and lived together, working jointly to obtain food.



Stone tools used by Peking Man 北京人使用的石器

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.6 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 6 页

Ash, burnt stones, and burnt bones have been found at the Peking Man site, showing that Peking Man already knew how to use fire. They used fire to roast food, keep warm, provide light, and drive away wild animals, thereby improving their living conditions. Learning to use fire was a milestone in the history of human evolution.



An artist's impression of Peking Man using fire 北京人用火场景想象图

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.6 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 6 页

The Zhoukoudian Peking Man site is one of the richest and most complete Homo erectus sites known in the world today. The discovery of Homo erectus remains within China, including those of Peking Man, is of great significance for the study of human origins and the history of early human evolution.

■ Think About It · 想一想

What evolutionary features does the head of Peking Man display?

① The average brain capacity of Peking Man was 1,088 ml, while the modern human average is 1,400 ml.

Upper Cave Man 山顶洞人 Shāndǐngdòngrén

About 30,000 years ago, another group of early humans lived in the area where Peking Man had been active. They looked the same as modern humans and belonged to late Homo sapiens. Their skeletal fossils were discovered in a cave at the top of Longgu Hill in Zhoukoudian, and archaeologists named them "Upper Cave Man".



Reconstructed bust of Upper Cave Man 山顶洞人复原头像

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.7 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 7 页

While continuing to use chipped stone tools, Upper Cave Man also began to make bone tools（骨器 gǔqì）, and had mastered polishing and drilling techniques. They may already have known how to make fire on their own. They lived by gathering and hunting; they could also fish and sew clothing. Their range of activity was quite large, and they had contact with other primitive groups. Upper Cave Man had a sense of beauty and also practised the burial of the dead.

Upper Cave Man lived a collective life. They lived together, used shared tools, worked together, and distributed food together, with no distinctions of wealth or status.



山顶洞人使用的骨针和装饰品

Bone needles and ornaments used by Upper Cave Man 山顶洞人使用的骨针和装饰品

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.7 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 7 页

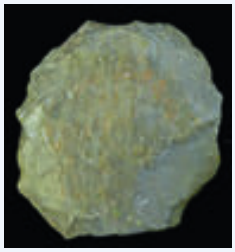
■ After-class Activities · 课后活动

1. Complete the table below, and describe the progress Upper Cave Man had made compared with Peking Man.

Name 名称	Type 类型	Period 生活年代	Brain capacity 脑容量	Tool-making 制作工具	Use of fire 用火状况
Peking Man 北京人	Homo erectus 直立人		average 1,088 ml 平均 1088 毫升		
Upper Cave Man 山顶洞人	late Homo sapiens 晚期智人		1,300–1,500 ml 1300—1500 毫升		

2. Draw lines to match each picture of the stone tools below with its name and description. Think about why archaeologists named them chopper, pointed tool, and scraper.







Tool A | 97×58×24 mm 长 97 毫米，宽 58 毫米，厚 24 毫米

Tool B | 151×142×31 mm 长 151 毫米，宽 142 毫米，厚 31 毫米

Tool C | 55×38×22 mm 长 55 毫米，宽 38 毫米，厚 22 毫米

① **Chopper（砍砸器 kǎnzáqì）:** no fixed shape; fairly large and easy to grip; mostly used to chop trees or strike wild animals. 器型不固定，较为粗大，便于手握，大多用来砍伐树木或打击野兽。

② **Pointed tool（尖状器 jiānzhuàngqì）:** has a pointed edge; mostly used for piercing or cutting. 有尖刃，多用来锥或割。

③ **Scraper（刮削器 guāxiāoqì）:** one edge has a protruding, irregular blade, used to scrape the surfaces of animal hides, wood, and bone. 一侧边缘有凸出的、不规则的刃，用以刮削兽皮、木、骨的表面。

■ Knowledge Extension · 知识拓展

Studying Human Origins with Ancient DNA Technology　古 DNA 技术研究人类起源

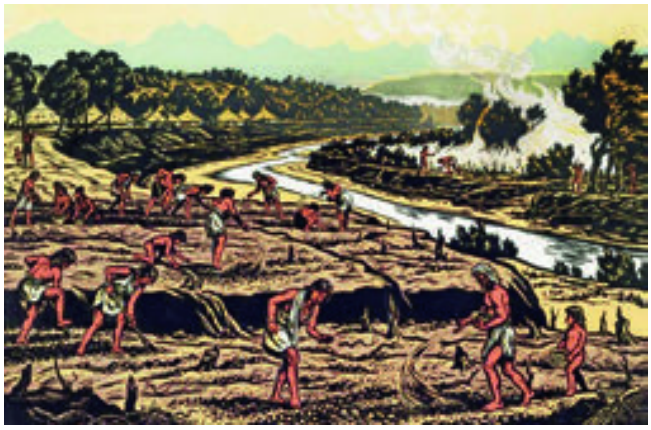
Deoxyribonucleic acid (DNA) is the carrier of an organism's genetic information. It contains almost all of an organism's genetic information, so by analysing an organism's DNA sequence we can trace its ancestral origins. DNA extracted from the remains of ancient organisms obtained through archaeological excavation and other means is called "ancient DNA"（古 DNA）. Because ancient remains have been buried underground for long periods and are affected by oxidation, hydrolysis, and other environmental processes, ancient DNA molecules are usually highly degraded, with incomplete sequences. However, with the aid of computers and bioinformatics methods, scientists can compare and analyse ancient DNA sequences, identify their similarities and differences, and thereby establish genealogical relationships among different ancient organisms — providing a biological perspective for the study of human origins.

Key Words 词汇表　Glossary with definitions · 英 ⇄ 中 ⇄ 拼音 ⇄ 释义

English	中文	Pinyin	Definition 释义
fossil	化石	huàshí	EN: Preserved remains or traces of an ancient organism. 中：古代生物的遗骸或遗迹经石化形成的遗存，是研究古人类历史的重要证据。
Stone Age	石器时代	Shíqì Shídài	EN: The period when humans mainly used stone tools, before metal tools appeared. 中：金属工具出现之前，人类以石器为主要生产工具的时代。
Paleolithic Age	旧石器时代	Jiùshíqì Shídài	EN: The Old Stone Age, when people mainly used chipped stone tools. 中：主要使用打制石器的时代。
chipped stone tool	打制石器	dǎzhì shíqì	EN: A stone tool made by striking flakes off a stone. 中：通过打制（敲击）石块制成的工具。
Homo erectus	直立人	zhílìrén	EN: An early human species that could walk fully upright; Peking Man belongs to it. 中：已能完全

			直立行走的古人类，北京人属于直立人。
Homo sapiens	智人	zhìrén	EN: The human species with modern physical features. 中：具有现代人体质特征的人类，现代人即晚期智人。
Yuanmou Man	元谋人	Yuánmóurén	EN: One of the earliest known early humans in China (c. 1.7 million years ago), found in Yunnan. 中：我国境内目前已知最早的古人类之一，发现于云南元谋，距今约 170 万年。
Peking Man	北京人	Běijīngrén	EN: Homo erectus who lived at Zhoukoudian, Beijing, c. 700,000–200,000 years ago. 中：生活在北京周口店的直立人，距今约 70 万—20 万年。
Upper Cave Man	山顶洞人	Shāndǐngdòngrén	EN: Late Homo sapiens who lived c. 30,000 years ago in a cave at the top of Longgu Hill. 中：距今约 3 万年生活在周口店龙骨山顶部洞穴的晚期智人。
Zhoukoudian	周口店	Zhōukǒudiàn	EN: The site near Beijing where the fossils of Peking Man and Upper Cave Man were discovered. 中：北京人与山顶洞人化石的发现地，位于北京西南。

Lesson 2 · Primitive Agriculture and Prehistoric Society 第 2 课 原始农业与史前社会



An artist's impression of primitive farming 原始农作场景想象图

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.9 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 9 页

This illustration depicts people farming with the slash-and-burn method in prehistoric① times. The appearance of agriculture changed the way people lived. How did primitive agriculture originate and develop in China? What inventions and creations of great significance to human civilization appeared in China's Neolithic Age②? And what features do the historical remains of this period display?

① The time before humans had written records is usually called "prehistory"（史前 shǐqián）.

② The age in which ground stone tools（磨制石器 mózhì shíqì）were mainly used is called the "Neolithic Age"（新石器时代 xīnshíqì shídài, New Stone Age）.

The Origins of Agriculture and Settled Life 农业的起源与定居生活

China is one of the places where agriculture originated in the world. During long periods of food gathering, the ancestors of the Chinese people gradually deepened their knowledge of various edible plants. About 20,000 years ago, they began to manage certain wild plants. About 10,000 years ago, artificially cultivated crops③ appeared in both northern and southern China. The world's earliest known cultivated rice, foxtail millet（粟 sù）, and broomcorn millet（黍 shǔ）have all been found in China. The artificial cultivation of rice, foxtail millet, and broomcorn millet was an important contribution made by our ancestors to human civilization.

The origin and development of agriculture promoted a settled human life. People made ground stone tools, produced pottery, and raised livestock. The productive forces of primitive society were raised. Primitive agriculture laid an important foundation for the formation of ancient civilized society.

③ Remains of early cultivated rice have been found at the Xianrendong site in Wannian (Jiangxi), the Yuchanyan site in Daoxian (Hunan), and the Shangshan site in Pujiang and the Qiaotou site in Yiwu (Zhejiang); remains of cultivated foxtail millet and broomcorn millet have been found at the Donghulin site in Mentougou (Beijing) and the Xinglongwa site in Aohan Banner (Inner Mongolia). 江西万年仙人洞遗址、湖南道县玉蟾岩遗址，以及浙江

浦江上山遗址、义乌桥头遗址等，发现了早期栽培水稻的遗存。北京门头沟东胡林遗址、内蒙古敖汉旗兴隆洼遗址等，发现了人工栽培的粟和黍遗存。



Carbonised rice grains unearthed at the Qiaotou site, Yiwu, Zhejiang 浙江义乌桥头遗址出土的炭化稻粒

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.9 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 9 页



北京门头沟东胡林遗址出土的
炭化粟粒和黍粒

Carbonised foxtail and broomcorn millet unearthed at the Donghulin site, Mentougou, Beijing 北京门头沟东胡林遗址出土的炭化粟粒和黍粒

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.9 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 9 页

■ Related History · 相关史事

Ancient people put clay containers into the fire to bake them, and thus the earliest pottery appeared. China was the earliest country to develop pottery-making technology. Pottery shards unearthed at the Xianrendong site in Wannian, Jiangxi, have been scientifically dated to about 20,000 years ago and are the earliest pottery currently known in the world. In addition, pottery more than 10,000 years old has been unearthed in Beijing, Hebei, Henan, Shandong, Hunan, and other places. After pottery was invented, humans could not only use it to cook food but also to store food and drinking water. This helped humans settle down and engage in agricultural production. Therefore, the making and use of pottery was of great significance to human life.



Distribution Map of Major Neolithic Sites in China 中国境内新石器时代重要遗址分布图

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.10 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 10 页

Legend 图例: ● Major Neolithic site 新石器时代重要遗址 ◎ Capital 首都 ○ Important location 重要地点 — National boundary 国界 ···· Boundary of province / autonomous region / municipality 省、自治区、直辖市界 -·- Boundary of special administrative region 特别行政区界 — Undemarcated boundary 未定国界 | Note 注: All elements on the map reflect present-day information（图中所有要素为今内容）.

Sites on the map 图中遗址: Shangshan 上山 · Qiaotou 桥头 · Xianrendong 仙人洞 · Yuchanyan 玉蟾岩 · Donghulin 东胡林 · Xinglongwa 兴隆洼 · Jiahu 贾湖 · Hemudu 河姆渡 · Banpo 半坡 · Xipo 西坡 · Xiyincun 西阴村 · Yangshaocun 仰韶村 · Dawenkou 大汶口 · Donghaiyu 东海峪 · Jiaojia 焦家 · Taosi 陶寺 · Shuanghuaishu 双槐树 · Lingjiatan 凌家滩 · Liangzhu 良渚 · Niuheliang 牛河梁 | Places 地点: Beijing 北京 · Xi'an 西安 · Yuyao 余姚 · Wannian 万年.

The Hemudu People and the Flourishing of Rice Farming 河姆渡人与稻作农业的繁荣

The middle and lower reaches of the Yangtze River and the Huai River basin were regions where China's prehistoric rice-farming① economy flourished. The Hemudu site（河姆渡遗址 Hémùdù yízhǐ）at Yuyao, Zhejiang, located in the lower Yangtze region, dates back about 7,000 years. The houses of the Hemudu people were mainly stilt-style buildings（干栏式建筑 gānlánshì jiànzhù）: wooden piles were driven into the ground, and the house was built on top with wooden planks and other

materials. Archaeologists also discovered a wooden-framed well at the site — one of the earliest wooden wells found anywhere so far.

The site also contains large quantities of rice remains. Bone spades（骨耜 gǔsì）, an advanced agricultural production tool, were widely used. Rice farming had already reached a considerable scale. Livestock raising focused on pigs and dogs, and people also hunted wild boar, deer, and other animals.

The Hemudu people knew how to use natural lacquer, and they could make pottery, jade objects, and simple musical instruments such as bone whistles（骨哨 gǔshào）. They also applied carving techniques, using ivory and animal bone to create simple, unadorned works of art. The earliest known ivory carving in China was unearthed here.

① An agricultural economy based mainly on growing rice is called “rice farming”（稻作农业 dàozuò nóngyè）.



An artist’s reconstruction of a Hemudu stilt-style building 河姆渡人干栏式建筑复原想象图

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.11 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 11 页



Bone spade with a wooden handle bound with rattan, unearthed at the Hemudu site 河姆渡遗址出土的带藤条残木柄骨耜

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.11 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 11 页



河姆渡遗址出土的双鸟朝阳纹象牙雕刻器及线描图

Ivory carving with the design of two birds facing the sun, and its line drawing, unearthed at the Hemudu site 河姆渡遗址出土的双鸟朝阳纹象牙雕刻器及线描图

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.11 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 11 页

■ Related History · 相关史事

In the upper Huai River region of central Henan today lies a primitive village site dating back about 9,000–7,500 years — the Jiahu site（贾湖遗址 Jiǎhú yízhǐ）at Wuyang. The Jiahu residents were able to make refined stone tools, pottery, and bone implements. Carbonised rice grains and the bones of domesticated pigs unearthed at the site prove that agriculture and animal husbandry had already begun to develop. Some of the turtle shells buried in the tombs have symbols carved on them. The bone flutes（骨笛 gǔdí）unearthed here are the world's earliest known flutes capable of playing a seven-note scale.



Turtle shell inscribed with symbols, and a bone flute, unearthed at the Jiahu site 贾湖遗址出土的刻符龟甲和骨笛

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.11 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 11 页

The Yangshao Culture and the Dawenkou Culture 仰韶文化和大汶口文化

The Yangshao Culture（仰韶文化 Yǎngsháo wénhuà）was mainly distributed in the middle reaches of the Yellow River, dating back about 7,000–5,000 years; it was named after its first discovery at the Yangshaocun site in Mianchi, Henan. The Yangshao people mainly engaged in foxtail-millet farming and lived a settled life. Painted pottery（彩陶 cǎitáo）with patterns of fish, birds, and flowers painted on the surface is an important feature of the Yangshao Culture.

The Banpo site（半坡遗址 Bànpō yízhǐ）, located at Banpo Village in eastern Xi'an, Shaanxi, dates back about 6,000 years and is an important Yangshao Culture site. The Banpo people mainly lived in semi-subterranean houses（半地穴式房屋 bàndìxuéshì fángwū）with hearth pits inside.

The Banpo people could make exquisite ground stone tools and engaged in agricultural production. They planted foxtail millet and broomcorn millet and raised pigs, dogs, and other livestock; they fished and hunted with bows and arrows and fishing spears; and they gathered wild fruits to supplement their food. The Banpo people also used ornaments in large quantities and made a musical instrument, the pottery xun（陶埙 táoxūn）. Bone needles（骨针 gǔzhēn）, bone awls（

骨锥 gǔzhuī）, and spindle whorls（纺轮 fǎnglún）made of pottery and stone have also been unearthed at the site, showing that the Banpo people already knew how to spin, weave, and make clothes.



An artist's reconstruction of a Banpo semi-subterranean house 半坡人半地穴式房屋复原想象图

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.12 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 12 页

■ Think About It · 想一想

Why were the Banpo people's houses different in type from those of the Hemudu people?



石锛　骨箭头　骨渔叉　陶埙　陶纺轮

半坡遗址出土的器具

Implements unearthed at the Banpo site: stone adze 石锛 · bone arrowhead 骨箭头 · bone fishing spear 骨渔叉 · pottery xun 陶埙 · pottery spindle whorl 陶纺轮 半坡遗址出土的器具

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.12 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 12 页

■ Related History · 相关史事

Archaeologists have successively discovered silkworm cocoons and fragments of silk fabrics, as well as silkworm-chrysalis and silkworm-shaped objects carved from bone, ivory, or stone, at Yangshao Culture sites in Shanxi and Henan. This shows that the Yangshao people were already able to raise silkworms and reel silk（养蚕缫丝 yǎngcán sāosī）to make silk fabrics. The invention of silk fabric was a major contribution made by our ancestors to human civilization.



Ivory carving of a silkworm unearthed at the Shuanghuaishu site, Gongyi, Henan 河南巩义双槐树遗址出土的牙雕蚕

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.12 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 12 页

The Yangshao Culture period was the heyday of clan① society. At the Xipo site（西坡遗址 Xīpō yízhǐ）in Lingbao, Henan, archaeologists discovered a large house with an area of more than 200 square metres. Located at the centre of a group of houses, it may have been the residence of a clan leader or a place for handling tribal affairs. Archaeologists have also discovered many public cemeteries of the Yangshao Culture. In early cemeteries dating back more than 6,000 years, there were no significant differences in tomb size or in the number of burial objects; clan members were equal in status, with no obvious gap between rich and poor. By the late Yangshao Culture period, around 5,000 years ago, clear differences appeared in tomb size and the number of burial objects.

The Dawenkou Culture（大汶口文化 Dàwènkǒu wénhuà）was mainly distributed in the lower reaches of the Yellow River and the middle and lower reaches of the Huai River, dating back about 5,900–4,400 years. In the late Dawenkou Culture, pottery-making technology developed considerably, and people could produce rather refined pottery. During this period, among the tombs in the same cemetery, some were buried with more than a hundred objects in complete sets, including exquisite jade articles, while others had nothing at all. This shows that a gap between rich and poor had already appeared within the same community.

① A clan（氏族 shìzú）is a social group in primitive society united by blood relations; its members generally share a common ancestor.



Foundations of the large house at the Xipo site, Lingbao, Henan 河南灵宝西坡遗址的大房子基址

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.13 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 13 页



成套玉器　　成套陶器

山东章丘焦家遗址的大汶口文化墓葬出土的随葬品

Burial objects from a Dawenkou Culture tomb at the Jiaojia site, Zhangqiu, Shandong: sets of jade articles 成套玉器 and sets of pottery 成套陶器 山东章丘焦家遗址的大汶口文化墓葬出土的随葬品

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.13 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 13 页

■ Related History · 相关史事

The Longshan Culture（龙山文化 Lóngshān wénhuà）was the successor of the Dawenkou Culture, dating back about 4,400–3,800 years. The Longshan Culture further developed pottery-making technology, and people could produce even more exquisite pottery. One type of pottery cup, black in colour and shiny all over, has walls less than 1 millimetre thick at the thinnest point and is called "egg-shell pottery"（蛋壳陶 dànkétáo）. Making such cups required stable, high-speed fast-wheel finishing technology and superb kiln-firing skills, showing that the productive forces of society at that time had already reached a relatively high level.



Egg-shell black pottery cup unearthed at the Donghaiyu site, Rizhao, Shandong 山东日照东海峪遗址出土的蛋壳黑陶杯

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.13 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 13 页

■ After-class Activities · 课后活动

1. Which of the following phenomena indicate the origin and development of primitive agriculture? Tick "√" in the boxes.

☐ The appearance of crops 农作物的出现　☐ Raising livestock 家畜饲养　☐ Settled life 定居生活

☐ Ground stone tools 磨制石器　☐ Making fire by artificial means 人工取火　☐ Making pottery 制作陶器

2. Look up reference materials, choose materials such as paper, wooden sticks, or clay, and make a replica of an artifact from this lesson that interests you. Add a written description, and tell your classmates about the features of the artifact you replicated.

■ Knowledge Extension · 知识拓展

Painted Pottery of the Yangshao Culture　仰韶文化彩陶

An important feature of the Yangshao Culture is the making of painted pottery. When making pottery,

people painted patterns on the surface of the clay body with mineral pigments; after firing, coloured designs remained on the surface — this is called “painted pottery”. Yangshao painted vessels include basins, bo bowls, bottles, and jars, with motifs including fish, birds, flowers, the sun, stars, and geometric patterns. Yangshao painted pottery is widely distributed, mainly in the middle reaches of the Yellow River, with its influence reaching the upper and lower Yellow River regions as well as the Yangtze River and West Liao River basins. The cross-regional development of Yangshao painted pottery is an important manifestation of the great flourishing of China’s prehistoric culture and reflects the influence of the prehistoric culture of the middle Yellow River region on its surroundings.



Pottery basin with human-face-and-fish design, unearthed at Banpo, Shaanxi 陕西半坡出土的人面鱼纹陶盆



Pottery basin with interlocking spiral design, unearthed at Linfen, Shanxi 山西临汾出土的回旋勾连纹陶盆



Pottery bottle with giant-salamander design, unearthed at Gangu, Gansu 甘肃甘谷出土的鲵鱼纹陶瓶



Pottery bo bowl with bird design, unearthed at Huazhou, Shaanxi 陕西华州出土的鸟纹陶钵



Pottery bo bowl with petal design, unearthed at Sanmenxia, Henan 河南三门峡出土的花瓣纹陶钵



Pottery jar with six-pointed-star design, unearthed at Gongyi, Henan 河南巩义出土的六角星纹陶罐

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.14 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 14 页

Key Words 词汇表 Glossary with definitions · 英 ⇄ 中 ⇄ 拼音 ⇄ 释义

English	中文	Pinyin	Definition 释义
Neolithic Age	新石器时代	xīnshíqì shídài	EN: The New Stone Age, when people mainly used ground stone tools. 中：主要使用磨制石器的时代。
ground stone tool	磨制石器	mózhì shíqì	EN: A stone tool made by grinding and polishing. 中：通过磨制加工的石器，新石器时代的主要工具。
foxtail millet	粟	sù	EN: A cereal crop first cultivated in northern China.

			中：我国北方最早人工栽培的粮食作物之一。
broomcorn millet	黍	shǔ	EN: A cereal crop first cultivated in ancient China. 中：我国最早人工栽培的粮食作物之一。
rice farming	稻作农业	dàozuò nóngyè	EN: An agricultural economy based mainly on growing rice. 中：以种植水稻为主的农业经济。
Hemudu site	河姆渡遗址	Hémùdù yízhǐ	EN: A c. 7,000-year-old rice-farming site at Yuyao, Zhejiang, known for stilt-style buildings. 中：位于浙江余姚、距今约 7000 年的稻作农业遗址，以干栏式建筑为特色。
Banpo site	半坡遗址	Bànpō yízhǐ	EN: A c. 6,000-year-old Yangshao Culture site near Xi'an, known for semi-subterranean houses. 中：位于陕西西安、距今约 6000 年的仰韶文化遗址，以半地穴式房屋为特色。
Yangshao Culture	仰韶文化	Yǎngsháo wénhuà	EN: A Neolithic culture (c. 7000–5000 BP) in the middle Yellow River region, famous for painted pottery. 中：主要分布在黄河中游、距今约 7000—5000 年的文化，以彩陶为重要特征。
painted pottery	彩陶	cǎitáo	EN: Pottery with coloured designs painted in mineral pigments before firing. 中：在泥坯表面用矿物颜料绘出图案、经烧制留下彩色纹样的陶器。
clan	氏族	shìzú	EN: A social group in primitive society united by blood relations, with a common ancestor. 中：原始社会以血缘关系结合的社会群体，成员一般有共同的祖先。

Lesson 3 · The Origins of Chinese Civilization 第 3 课 中华文明的起源



Statues of the Yan Emperor (right) and the Yellow Emperor (left), Zhengzhou, Henan 位于河南郑州的炎帝（右）、黄帝（左）雕像

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.15 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 15 页

The giant statues in this picture depict the legendary Yan Emperor and Yellow Emperor, who are honoured as the cultural ancestors of the Chinese nation. Archaeological discoveries confirm that Chinese civilization has a history of more than 5,000 years. What are the origins and characteristics of Chinese civilization? Ancient legends tell stories of the Yan Emperor, the Yellow Emperor, Yao, Shun, and Yu — what history do these legends reflect?

The Early State and the Origins of Civilization 早期国家和文明的起源

More than 5,000 years ago, agriculture and animal husbandry in China's primitive society developed considerably. The population grew significantly and began to concentrate in regional centres, and early cities gradually took shape. Towering city walls, broad moats, and large-scale water conservancy facilities provided security and convenience for city life. Differentiation among members of society intensified: some people broke away from productive labour to specialise in management, and a king（王 wáng）appeared who held political, economic, military, and sacrificial power. The ruling class, headed by the king, ruled internally and waged wars externally, thereby forming the early state. The emergence of private ownership, classes, and the state is an important marker of humanity's entry into civilized society.



Jade pig-dragon unearthed at the Niuheliang site 牛河梁遗址出土的玉猪龙

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.15 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 15 页



Stone-pile tombs and altars at the Niuheliang site 牛河梁遗址的积石冢、祭坛

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.15 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 15 页

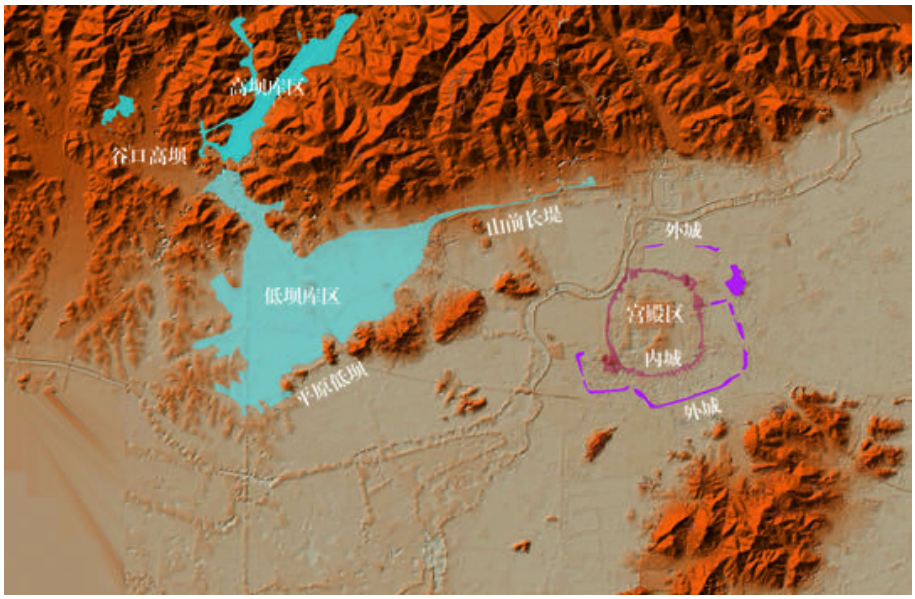
■ Related History · 相关史事

The Niuheliang site（牛河梁遗址 Niúhéliáng yízhǐ）, located in Chaoyang, Liaoning, belongs to the Hongshan Culture（红山文化 Hóngshān wénhuà）of the West Liao River basin and dates back about 5,800–5,000 years. The site contains altars, a goddess temple, and stone-pile tombs（积石冢 jīshízhǒng）in which nobles were buried, reflecting the social differentiation and sacrificial rituals of the late Hongshan Culture.

Liangzhu City and Taosi City 良渚古城与陶寺古城

The Liangzhu City site（良渚古城遗址 Liángzhǔ gǔchéng yízhǐ）is located in Yuhang, Zhejiang, and dates back about 5,300–4,300 years. The ancient city consists of a palace district, an inner city, and an outer city. The inner city covers about 3 million square metres and the outer city about 6.3 million square metres — a scale second to none in the world at that time. To the north and northwest of the city was a complex water conservancy system composed of man-made dams and natural hills — the largest hydraulic engineering project in the world at that time. In the middle of the inner city stood a man-made raised platform, on which a large square and several groups of high-grade buildings were constructed; about 200,000 kilograms of carbonised rice were discovered nearby. These discoveries reflect the relatively high level of economic development of Liangzhu society and the strong ability of its rulers to mobilise and organise people.

In the aristocratic cemeteries inside and outside the city, dozens to hundreds of exquisite jade objects were buried, including jade cong（玉琮 yùcóng）and jade bi discs（玉璧 yùbì）used in sacrifices, and jade yue axes（玉钺 yùyuè）symbolising military command. This contrasts sharply with the ordinary cemeteries outside the city, where burial objects were scarce, showing that groups of different status and rank were buried in different areas and that class differentiation in society had already become quite obvious. The archaeological discoveries at Liangzhu City confirm that about 5,000 years ago an early state had already appeared in the lower Yangtze region.

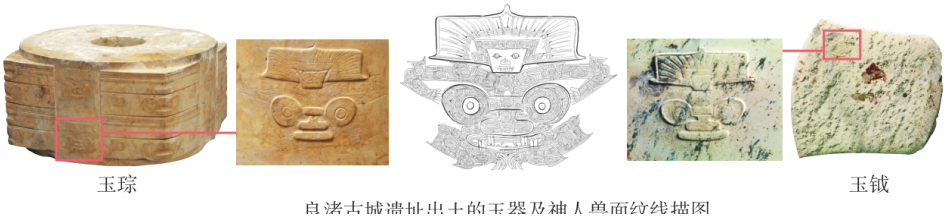


Structural diagram of Liangzhu City and its peripheral water conservancy system 良渚古城及外围水利系统结构示意图

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.16 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 16 页

■ Related History · 相关史事

Many jade objects of the Liangzhu Culture are incised with a "spirit-human and beast-mask" motif（神人兽面纹 shénrén-shòumiàn wén）, whose main body consists of a mythical beast flying across the sky and a feather-crowned spirit figure riding on its back. Archaeological discoveries show that the various elements of this motif on Liangzhu jades are remarkably uniform. The motif is therefore also called the "divine emblem"（神徽 shénhuī）of the Liangzhu Culture. This reflects that the Liangzhu people had very likely already formed a unified object of worship.



Jade objects unearthed at the Liangzhu City site and a line drawing of the spirit-human and beast-mask motif: jade cong 玉琮 (left) · jade yue axe 玉钺 (right) 良渚古城遗址出土的玉器及神人兽面纹线描图

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.17 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 17 页

The Taosi City site（陶寺古城遗址 Táosì gǔchéng yízhǐ）is located in Xiangfen, Shanxi, and dates back about 4,300–4,000 years. Taosi City covers an area of 2.8 million square metres, with a walled palace city inside. Within the palace city are many high-grade building foundations, as well as pottery building materials. There are many cemeteries within the city, with large tombs concentrated together. These tombs were often buried with pottery drums, stone qing chimes（石磬 shíqìng）, jade yue axes, pottery plates, and other objects, indicating the noble status of the tomb owners. Many small tombs contain no burial objects at all, and in some aristocratic cemeteries

archaeologists have discovered the practice of using humans as burial sacrifices, showing that differences in social status between groups were marked and class differentiation was severe. The burial objects in the large tombs came from a wide range of sources, reflecting the convergence of cultural elements from various regions into the Central Plains. Small bronze objects and pottery pots bearing written symbols have also been unearthed in the city, and remains that may have been an observatory have been discovered. The discovery of the Taosi City site shows that an early state had already appeared in the middle Yellow River region at that time①.

① From the location and period of Taosi City, some scholars infer that it may well have been the capital of Yao in ancient historical legends.

■ Think About It · 想一想

Based on the archaeological discoveries at Liangzhu City and Taosi City, explain why we say that society had already entered civilization at that time.



陶寺古城遗址出土的器物

Objects unearthed at the Taosi City site: bronze gear-shaped object 铜齿轮形器 · jade animal mask 玉兽面 · painted pottery plate with dragon design 彩绘龙纹陶盘 · pottery pot with symbols in vermilion 朱书符号陶壶 · stone qing chime 石磬　陶寺古城遗址出土的器物

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.17 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 17 页

Archaeological discoveries such as Liangzhu City and Taosi City show that the origins and early development of Chinese civilization are characterised by pluralistic integration. About 5,000 years ago, the Yellow River, Yangtze River, and West Liao River basins each developed distinctive early civilizations, which continually exchanged and merged with one another and together formed the main body of early Chinese civilization. More than 4,000 years ago, the Central Plains rose rapidly on the basis of extensively absorbing elements of civilizations from various regions and, through sustained development, moved toward integration — a new pattern of civilization led by the Central Plains began to take shape.

Legends of Remote Antiquity　远古的传说

Many legends about the deeds of ancient ancestors have been passed down in China, and the Yan Emperor and the Yellow Emperor are the most famous figures among them.

Five to six thousand years ago, China entered the period of tribal alliances. According to legend, several large tribes, including those of the Yan Emperor, the Yellow Emperor, and Chiyou（蚩尤

Chīyóu）, were active in the Yellow River basin at that time. The Yellow Emperor united some tribes and fought a great battle against the Yan Emperor at Banquan（阪泉 Bǎnquán）. In the end the Yan Emperor was defeated and submitted to the Yellow Emperor, and the two tribes formed an alliance. Later, the Yan-Huang tribal alliance fought a fierce battle at Zhuolu（涿鹿 Zhuōlù）against the Chiyou tribe from the east; Chiyou was finally defeated, and part of his tribe submitted to the Yan-Huang alliance. The power and prestige of the Yan-Huang tribal alliance increased greatly, and the Yellow Emperor was elected leader of the alliance. This tribal alliance gradually evolved into what later became the Huaxia people（华夏族 Huáxiàzú）. Later generations honoured the Yan Emperor and the Yellow Emperor as the cultural ancestors（人文初祖 rénwén chūzǔ）of the Chinese nation, and since modern times, Chinese people at home and abroad have also called themselves "descendants of Yan and Huang"（炎黄子孙 yánhuáng zǐsūn）.

According to legend, after the Yellow Emperor, Yao（尧 Yáo）, Shun（舜 Shùn）, and Yu（禹 Yǔ）successively became leaders. At that time the abdication system（禅让制 shànràng zhì）was practised, under which a leader passed his position to a person of virtue and ability. Yao encouraged people to develop production. When he grew old, he sought the opinions of the various tribes and recommended Shun, a man of noble character, as his successor. During Shun's reign, he established penal laws, improved institutions, and stabilised the situation; he also sent Yu to tame the floodwaters and eliminate the flooding. When Shun grew old, he yielded his position to Yu. Yu was loved by the people for his success in controlling the flood and was honoured as "Yu the Great"（大禹 Dà Yǔ）.

■ Source Study · 材料研读

"The Huaxia nation was not formed by a single people. Since high antiquity, various peoples lived intermingled, in contact and communication with one another; each cast off minor differences and moved toward a greater commonality, gradually blending together into the form of one people — these are the so-called Zhu Xia (various Xia) of later generations."

— Liang Qichao（梁启超）, Records of High Antiquity and the Three Dynasties（《太古及三代载记》）

华夏民族，非一族所成。太古以来，诸族错居，接触交通，各去小异而大同，渐化合以成一族之形，后世所谓诸夏是也。

Q: From the source, what features can you see in the formation of the Huaxia people?

■ Learning Virtue from History · 学史崇德

According to legend, floodwaters raged at that time. Yu's father Gun（鲧 Gǔn）was ordered by Shun to control the flooding. He adopted the method of blocking and damming, but after many years he still had not succeeded and was later put to death. Yu took over the flood-control work from his father, learned the lesson, and adopted the method of channeling and dredging, cutting canals to lead the

floodwaters into the sea. After more than ten years of effort, the flooding was finally eliminated. Yu devoted himself utterly to taming the flood, putting public duty above personal concerns — "three times he passed the door of his home without entering"（三过其门而不入）. Later generations have used this expression to describe the spirit of devotion to sacrificing one's small family for the greater whole.



Rubbing of a pictorial stone showing Yu the Great taming the flood (detail) 大禹治水画像石拓片（局部）

Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.19 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 19 页

■ After-class Activities · 课后活动

1. Describe the significance of archaeological remains and artifacts, together with ancient legends, for understanding the origins of Chinese civilization.

2. The Mausoleum of the Yellow Emperor（黄帝陵 Huángdì Líng）is located north of Huangling County town in Shaanxi Province. Every year around the Qingming Festival, large numbers of descendants of Yan and Huang from home and abroad come here to pay their respects, and on ordinary days visitors come in an endless stream. If you were a tour guide at the Mausoleum of the Yellow Emperor, write a tour-guide script introducing the deeds of the Yellow Emperor to visitors, covering his life and main contributions.



The Mausoleum of the Yellow Emperor 黄帝陵 *Source · 出处: PEP History of China, Grade 7 Vol. 1, p.19 人教版《中国历史》七年级上册 第 19 页*

■ Knowledge Extension · 知识拓展

The Project to Trace the Origins of Chinese Civilization 中华文明探源工程

The Project to Trace the Origins of Chinese Civilization（中华文明探源工程 Zhōnghuá wénmíng tànyuán gōngchéng）takes archaeology and history as its foundation and extensively applies methods from the natural sciences — geology, geography, physics, chemistry, biology, and others — to conduct comprehensive research. It has put forward a Chinese proposal for the criteria for judging entry into civilized society. It has revealed the historical process of the origin, formation, and early development of Chinese civilization, turning “five thousand years of Chinese civilization” from legend into credible history, and providing powerful spiritual motivation for strengthening the cultural confidence of the Chinese nation.

Key Words 词汇表 Glossary with definitions · 英 ⇄ 中 ⇄ 拼音 ⇄ 释义

English	中文	Pinyin	Definition 释义
early state	早期国家	zǎoqī guójiā	EN: The earliest form of state, marked by cities, social classes, and royal power. 中：以城市出现、阶级分化和王权形成为标志的早期国家形态。
pluralistic integration	多元一体	duōyuán yìtǐ	EN: The pattern in which multiple regional civilizations developed in parallel and merged into one. 中：多个区域文明并行发展、在交流融合中走向一体的特征。
Liangzhu Culture	良渚文化	Liángzhǔ wénhuà	EN: A Neolithic culture in the lower Yangtze region, known for its walled city, dams, and fine jades. 中：长江下游的新石器时代文化，以古城、水利系统和精美玉器著称。
jade cong	玉琮	yùcóng	EN: A rectangular jade tube used in rituals by the Liangzhu people. 中：良渚文化用于祭祀的方柱形玉礼器。
Taosi City	陶寺古城	Táosì gǔchéng	EN: A c. 4300–4000 BP city site in Xiangfen, Shanxi, possibly the capital of Yao. 中：位于山西襄汾、距今约 4300—4000 年的古城遗址，有可能是传说中尧的都城。
Yan Emperor	炎帝	Yán Dì	EN: A legendary tribal leader honoured, together with the Yellow Emperor, as a cultural ancestor of the Chinese nation. 中：传说中的部落首领，与黄帝同被尊奉为中华民族的人文初祖。
Yellow Emperor	黄帝	Huáng Dì	EN: The legendary leader of the Yan-Huang tribal alliance, honoured as a cultural ancestor of the Chinese nation. 中：炎黄部落联盟首领，被尊奉为中华民族的人文初祖。
Huaxia people	华夏族	Huáxiàzú	EN: The people that gradually formed from the Yan-Huang tribal alliance, ancestor of the Chinese nation. 中：由炎黄部落联盟逐渐演化形成的族体，是中华民族的前身。
abdication system	禅让制	shànràng zhì	EN: The legendary practice of a leader passing his

			position to a virtuous, capable successor. 中：传说中首领把位子传给贤德之人的制度。
Yu the Great	大禹	Dà Yǔ	EN: The legendary hero who tamed the great flood by channeling rivers to the sea. 中：传说中以疏导方法治理洪水成功的英雄，被尊称为“大禹”。

Source 出处: 人民教育出版社《中国历史》七年级上册（2024 年版），第一单元《史前时期：原始社会与中华文明的起源》，第 2–19 页。English translation prepared for classroom use at Mingwan School; structure, boxes and activities follow the original textbook. 仅供课堂教学使用。